THREE PRESSURES HITTING YOUR CLIENTS' SHELF POSITION

Your clients' shelf space is *under quiet attack* right now

We track the functional & non-alc beverage space continuously so your team doesn't have to. This month the story isn't a fun new flavor — it's **survival on the shelf**. Three forces are squeezing your beverage clients at once, and each one has a marketing move that protects them. Here's what we're seeing.

$2.49

THE SQUEEZE · PRICE & SUGAR

Functional soda is undercutting kombucha on price, sugar and taste at once

Olipop and Poppi are growing **50–100% a year**, landing at **$2.29–2.79** with just 2–5g sugar and a soda-familiar taste. Kombucha sits at **$3.99** with 8g sugar — same prebiotic claim, worse on every axis a shopper weighs at the shelf. The data shows they're **increasingly choosing the soda**.

> THE MOVE Stop selling "fermentation" and start selling **taste, low sugar, and everyday value.** Health-Ade already launched a "Plus" line to answer this exact threat — clients who don't reposition get shelf-displaced quietly.

Price ceiling

THE LEAK · PREMIUM PRICE CEILING

Premium positioning is hitting a price wall with cost-conscious buyers

Functional drinks are **priced at a premium** versus conventional soft drinks — and that premium is now **capping penetration** with price-sensitive shoppers just as cheaper functional sodas flood in. The brands winning are the ones closing the perceived value gap, not defending a high price on claim alone.

> THE MOVE Justify the premium or lose it. The fix is usually marketing, not price: make the **cost-per-benefit obvious** — "one can replaces your $X habit" — so the higher shelf price reads as the smart buy, not the expensive one.

27%

THE OPENING · WHERE GROWTH HIDES

Fiber sodas are 6% of the market but 27% of the growth

While brands fight on crowded ground, fiber- and prebiotic-based sodas hold only **~6%** of the beverage market yet drive **27%** of category growth — "overcontribution relative to size." Most clients are under-indexed here, and the brands naming specific fiber sources (cassava, inulin) are claiming the space first.

> THE MOVE Point client spend at the **fastest-growing, least-crowded** corner of the category. A brand that builds its story around one named fiber **owns that claim** before competitors notice the lane exists.

WANT TO SEE THE FULL PICTURE?

The complete *Monthly Margin & Opportunity Report* goes deeper — built around your clients' exact niche.

Every month we compile a full briefing — scored opportunities, ready-to-use templates, and ad angles — delivered as work product your team can use the same day. Reply if you want to see what it looks like.

Reply to *see a sample* report

We'll follow up within 2 days

EVERY MONTHLY BRIEFING INCLUDES ✓ 4–6 scored opportunities ✓ 3–5 email templates ✓ 2–3 ad angles ✓ Real-time alerts